Short Working

A new CEA link proposal — what would change for you

For discussion · from January 2027 · 26 weeks · code SWK-26-F1

The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

35h

the contracted week, as now

no extra hours

5

most days in a row

up to 7 · today 7–9

14

full weekends off a year

today 10

9 of 15

shift times you already work

6 new ones

30 min

off every closing shift

up to 45 min

Same hours, shorter closers, never two closing weeks in a row, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.

Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it

A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the new link follows in January 2027.

More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.

New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the close and at 22:00. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.

The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.

Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

	Today	Short Working
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Contracted days at work a week	4.20	**4.19**
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	**218.6**

No. The same 35-hour week on average; weeks run 24h 30m–42h 30m Monday to Saturday (today 25h 10m–43h 50m), and two more days a year are Saturdays.

Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours — and a swap for a late earns less overtime

	Today	Short Working
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter	26	**28**
Sunday overtime to share — each, a year	21	**20**
A late against an early, same day, on average	32 min longer	**▲ 20 min shorter**
Finishing at 13:35 or 13:45 — each, a year	26	**▲ 0**

No. Basic pay stays the same. Premium and overtime pay come to about £250 a year less, gross, if you work your share of Sundays. That assumes no swap overtime.

Will my shifts be longer?

Closing shifts get shorter, earlies longer — the average goes up about two minutes

	Today	Short Working
Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15	8h 40m	✓ 8h 10m
Saturday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:45	9h 10m	✓ 8h 40m
Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30	8h 55m	✓ 8h 10m
Average early, Monday to Saturday	7h 59m	▲ 8h 26m
Average late, Monday to Saturday	8h 29m	✓ 8h 06m
Average shift, Monday to Saturday	8h 14m	▲ 8h 16m

Every closing shift is 30 to 45 minutes shorter; the longest early Monday to Saturday goes from 8h 30m to 9h 00m, and nothing runs over 9 hours.

Will I finish late more often?

3 more a year at 23:00 or later (42, today 39); 14 more at 22:00 or later (92, today 78)

	Today	Short Working
Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year	39	▲ 42
Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year	78	▲ 92
Starting at 06:20 — each, a year	62	**60**
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	✓ 14h 20m

More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; the three more at 23:00 or later are the fewest the rules allow.

Will I know the times?

15 shift times in all — 9 of them you already work

You work these today (9)

06:20–14:00
06:20–14:20
06:20–14:50
07:15–15:45
08:00–16:30
12:00–20:00
13:30–21:00
14:00–22:30
15:15–23:55

New times (6)

- Closers start later: 30 minutes on weekdays, 45 minutes on Sundays
- A 9-hour weekday early, 07:00–16:00, and a new late, 15:00–22:30
- Weekends: the ticket-office late, 14:30–22:30
- On Sundays: a 9-hour early, 09:00–18:00

Fewer shift times than today (15, not 18) — and on a Saturday only the ticket-office late is new.

Rest and weekends

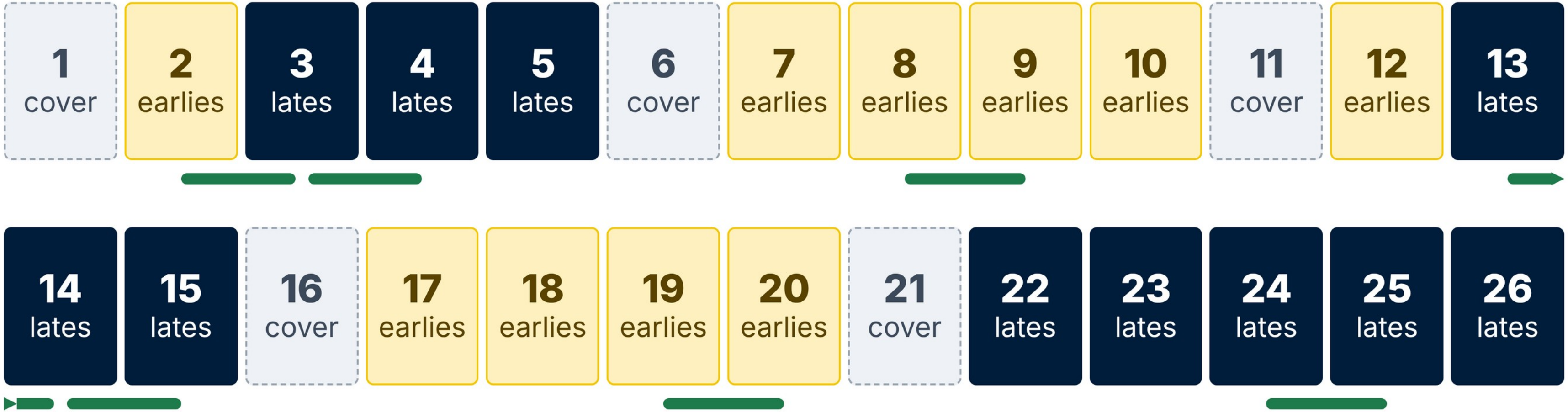
The biggest improvement over today

	Today	Short Working
Full weekends off, about a year	10	✓ 14
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	✓ 5 (up to 7)
Rest-day breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	✓ 22 of 26
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	✓ 14h 20m
Weeks on one shift time, all earlies or all lates	7 of 16	✓ 19 of 21

14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.

Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later



1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
cover	earlies	lates	lates	lates	cover	earlies	earlies	earlies	earlies	cover	earlies	lates

14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26
lates	lates	cover	earlies	earlies	earlies	earlies	cover	lates	lates	lates	lates	lates

🟨 all earlies ■ all lates ⬚ cover week, duties placed later ▬ full weekend off ▶ carries on in the next row

Blocks of earlies or lates up to 5 weeks, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way; a full weekend off comes round at least every five weeks.

Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

	Today	**Short Working**
Days off in a row — best place to book	30	▲ 28
Days off in a row — on average	23.4	**23.4**
Days off in a row — worst place	19	✓ 20
Leave for four full weeks off, at best	14	▲ 15

Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday, costs 15 days’ leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.

More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, and more at the open and the close on most days

	Today	Short Working
On duty on a weekday	11–12	✓ **15**
On duty on a Saturday / Sunday	10 / 8	✓ **14 / 10**
Fewest rostered on the floor	2	✓ **3**
Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside	4 (up to 5)	✓ **0 (up to 1)**

At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside.

The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

Six new shift times to learn
Four shorter versions of today’s lates, a longer weekday early and the 9-hour Sunday early.

Earlies or lates in longer runs
Up to 5 weeks of one kind, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way (today 2, up to 3).

Four weeks off: 15 days’ leave, not 14
The least leave for four complete weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday.

Two more Saturdays a year
28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

More late finishes
42 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39), and 92 at 22:00 or later (today 78).

Fewer early finishes and long breaks
None finish before 14:00 (today 26 a year each); no breaks of 3 days or more (today 13 a year).

None of these is hidden: every figure here is worked out from the rota.

At a glance

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more weekends off, fewer days in a row

	Today	Short Working
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	218.6
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	8h 16m · 9h 00m
Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	**8h 10m · 8h 40m · 8h 10m**
Full weekends off, about a year	10	**14**
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 7)**
Shortest rest between shifts	12h 30m	14h 20m
Different shift times	18	15 (9 you know)
On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11–12 · 10 · 8	15 · 14 · 10
Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside	4 (up to 5)	0 (up to 1)

The costs: more late finishes, longer runs of earlies or lates, longer weekday earlies and 15 days' leave for four weeks off.

What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell Sara Silva or your manager what worries you, even if it is small
3. Sara Silva, the RMT rep, is leading the change

SWK-26-F1 · every figure worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app and its tooling